

0:0:0.0 --> 0:0:4.90

INTERVIEWER - GA

OK, we are live. I was looking, I well well.

0:0:4.830 --> 0:0:5.730

INTERVIEWER - GA

Can't say your name.

0:0:17.40 --> 0:0:18.410

FR13

Yeah, I get it.

0:0:20.30 --> 0:0:20.750

INTERVIEWER - GA

Try it again here.

0:0:26.630 --> 0:0:41.880

INTERVIEWER - GA

Alright, so to start out one, thank you for being here and participating. I was hoping you could just give a little bit of background about how you got into the field of being a first responder or how long you've been doing it. Just a quick little intro.

0:0:42.590 --> 0:0:52.780

FR13

Yeah, my story is a little unique as far as how I got into the field. So I actually worked on [SHIP].

0:0:53.610 --> 0:1:19.260

FR13

And to do that you have to basically take like a two week basic firefighting certification course. The Navy wants you to do that because basically the employees on the ship are responsible if anything happens. So that was kind of the background on that. And I joined like the fire team on the ship and I was like, oh, this is kind of cool and you know, I kind of when I got done with my contract in [LOCATION REDACTED], it came back here and

0:1:19.920 --> 0:1:37.760

FR13

It took me a while to figure out what I wanted to do, but I I was like, well, I'm gonna give this firefighting/paramedic thing a try. And so I I went through school and did that and just fell in love with it. Instantly knew this is what I'm supposed to do. You know, this is where I belong type of thing. So I did that and

0:1:39.30 --> 0:1:42.730

FR13

I've been on the department I'm at now for [MORE THAN HALF A DECADE].

0:1:43.780 --> 0:1:54.350

FR13

Five of them full time. So I'm still, you know, relatively new I guess you would say in the fire service, but that's about how long I've been on now, so.

0:1:55.560 --> 0:2:0.130

INTERVIEWER - GA

That's such a unique story when you say [SHIP], it was it was a cruise ship.

0:2:0.510 --> 0:2:2.220

FR13

No, it was just a

0:2:6.690 --> 0:2:7.180

INTERVIEWER - GA

Wow.

0:2:18.480 --> 0:2:19.720

INTERVIEWER - GA

Right, yeah.

0:2:3.120 --> 0:2:28.10

FR13

[MORE DETAILS ABOUT WORK ON THE SHIP].

0:2:28.830 --> 0:2:32.500

INTERVIEWER - GA

That's such a great story. Well, we'll jump right in.

0:2:33.780 --> 0:2:37.230

INTERVIEWER - GA

What does occupational stress mean to you?

0:2:41.60 --> 0:2:43.30

FR13

Occupational stress to me um

0:2:44.330 --> 0:2:51.20

FR13

I would say it means a handful of different things. It's mental, it's physical.

0:2:52.450 --> 0:2:53.50

FR13

It's-

0:2:54.770 --> 0:3:25.580

FR13

There's so many things that entail being a first responder that can be stressful, even subconsciously, you know, kind of anticipating what could happen or what the next run could be, or, you know, especially being in the firefighter/paramedic world, we have a lot of topics that we are supposed to be

professionals at and and be the ones that when people call, we have to figure it out. So just that mental stress.

0:3:25.680 --> 0:3:52.470

FR13

Umm, definitely comes with the job, let alone obviously just some of the stuff we see and have to go through. But that's kind of the things that I think people don't think about with occupational stress is the the what could be or you know I have so many different topics and specialties that I'm responsible for learning and being proficient at. So those are kind of the mental stressors of the job and then.

0:3:53.190 --> 0:4:4.600

FR13

I mean, obviously, the physical stressors of the job of just being physically fit enough and strong enough and just physically able and healthy, all of those kind of to me

0:4:5.930 --> 0:4:7.860

FR13

Are occupational stressors.

0:4:9.560 --> 0:4:18.200

INTERVIEWER - GA

So you you broke it up into two categories you know you said you identified mental and physical stress. Do you think those-

0:4:19.780 --> 0:4:28.830

INTERVIEWER - GA

If there was, if there's an interplay between the two, do you think one can contribute to the other or vice versa? Or do you see them as more independent?

0:4:29.970 --> 0:4:33.820

FR13

No, I mean I would say that they're related if-

0:4:34.530 --> 0:4:46.930

FR13

If I'm mentally stressed from the job or you know I find myself having some anxiousness about the job, even subconsciously, that leads into physical fatigue.

0:4:48.110 --> 0:5:12.440

FR13

Because you know, my brain is spinning all the time and stressing about, you know, what's to come or whatever. And then that leads to just physically being more tired, more fatigue than I normally would on a day-to-day basis. And then obviously if I go out on the job and do something very physically demanding, I'm going to be mentally exhausted after that. So I would definitely say they coincide together.

0:5:13.900 --> 0:5:27.570

INTERVIEWER - GA

Do you think that the like in your line of work and you know, speaking for yourself specifically, do you think you endure more of a mental stress, a physical stress, or about an even combination?

0:5:28.290 --> 0:5:32.120

FR13

I would definitely say mental just because

0:5:32.920 --> 0:5:55.170

FR13

We don't fight fire all day, every day. That's where the majority of the physical stuff is going to come from. And then even if we go out and do fire trainings, those are physical, but they typically, you know, last an hour or two. And if I go in and work out, that only lasts an hour or so, maybe a couple hours of my day are, you know, physically demanding. But,

0:5:55.810 --> 0:6:1.400

FR13

I would say the majority on a day-to-day basis is going to be the mental aspect of it for sure.

0:6:3.80 --> 0:6:7.80

INTERVIEWER - GA

That's great. That's great uh, information, do you think?

0:6:7.890 --> 0:6:17.830

INTERVIEWER - GA

Well, what what would be helpful then from a mental standpoint as far as stress reduction is concerned on the job, if you're on the job feeling stress like what would be help for helpful to you?

0:6:18.570 --> 0:6:20.400

INTERVIEWER - GA

In that moment or afterwards?

0:6:24.40 --> 0:6:26.420

FR13

That's a good question. So for me.

0:6:25.570 --> 0:6:27.840

INTERVIEWER - GA

If you could have anything, I'll I'll preface that.

0:6:28.50 --> 0:6:43.100

FR13

Yeah. So for me, I have a good background in just physical fitness. So that's how I deal with my mental stressors is go and physically exhaust myself. So that's what I I personally do.

0:6:44.840 --> 0:6:48.710

FR13

But I have also benefited from.

0:6:49.540 --> 0:6:57.280

FR13

Obviously, just having communications with maybe somebody else that I work with that's, you know feeling the same type of stressors.

0:6:57.940 --> 0:6:59.190

FR13

Umm so.

0:7:0.200 --> 0:7:7.200

FR13

I guess being able to have that line of communication has been helpful as well.

0:7:8.30 --> 0:7:9.410

FR13

It's kind of a tough question.

0:7:10.50 --> 0:7:10.570

INTERVIEWER - GA

Yeah.

0:7:12.330 --> 0:7:15.850

FR13

If you could have anything, maybe a nap.

0:7:17.650 --> 0:7:18.390

INTERVIEWER - GA

A nap, OK.

0:7:16.860 --> 0:7:20.330

FR13

That's that's usually my favorite thing is just take a nap.

0:7:27.70 --> 0:7:27.470

FR13

Umm.

0:7:20.990 --> 0:7:32.540

INTERVIEWER - GA

So you mentioned, you know, exercises that you you physically exhaust yourself and that seems to help with the mental component. Is that something that's available to you on the job?

0:7:32.10 --> 0:7:32.630

FR13

It is.

0:7:33.350 --> 0:7:35.740

INTERVIEWER - GA

Where etween a run you could do something like that?

0:7:36.0 --> 0:7:39.430

FR13

Yeah, we have the opportunity. We have a great

0:7:40.180 --> 0:8:6.240

FR13

Gym, with a lot of equipment in there that, I mean we can we've got treadmills and we've got weights and we've got different setups. So really it's kind of whatever we wanna do. If it's a a 15 minute stretching session, if it's a a 45 minute heavy lifting session, if it's a a cardio session, you know we can do any of those things as long as we're obviously not out on a call so

0:8:7.250 --> 0:8:9.870

FR13

That's definitely something that we strive to do at least

0:8:10.580 --> 0:8:15.440

FR13

At the station that I work at daily is some manner of physical fitness.

0:8:16.100 --> 0:8:24.370

INTERVIEWER - GA

OK. Can you tell me about a a time or like a scenario where you either physically or mentally felt really overwhelmed

0:8:25.390 --> 0:8:26.100

INTERVIEWER - GA

During your job?

0:8:25.530 --> 0:8:29.900

FR13

Yeah, yeah, I would say.

0:8:31.880 --> 0:8:32.990

FR13

UM.

0:8:34.150 --> 0:8:37.770

FR13

I mean, do you want examples of both or just one or the other?

0:8:37.60 --> 0:8:42.270

INTERVIEWER - GA

Whatever comes to mind, if something you know sticks out to you as a particular event. If you don't mind sharing.

0:8:42.450 --> 0:8:50.720

FR13

No, no. Yeah. So so I have a couple. The physical one that comes to mind was actually a training that I went to

0:8:52.990 --> 0:8:56.180

FR13

That I knew going into the training was going to be

0:8:56.890 --> 0:9:0.460

FR13

Difficult. It was going to be very realistic. Very

0:9:1.280 --> 0:9:18.630

FR13

Go getter. We're going to be physically exhausted, like we're going to work really hard and this is going to be very realistic scenario as a live fire training. So the conditions were very, very, very heavy black smoke. You can't see your hand in front of your face. You know, you're you're going and doing all these things. We would in real life but

0:9:19.850 --> 0:9:25.700

FR13

Probably a little more extreme because a lot of the house fires we go into where I work

0:9:26.450 --> 0:9:29.780

FR13

We can catch them for the most part, early enough to where it's not

0:9:30.540 --> 0:10:0.590

FR13

Some crazy hard scenario if that makes sense. So I went out there with actually a couple of people that I work with and we were in the middle of an evolution and I was on the nozzle of the I was on the fire attack nozzle so my job was to go put the fire out and there was a bunch of people working in coordination and like I said, you can't see anything. It's hectic. It's really hot. I'm getting steam burnt and I can't see and we don't know where the fire is. And mind you, it's a training

0:10:0.670 --> 0:10:30.880

FR13

Evolution. So I knew that in the back of my head that it was gonna be OK, but after being in this situation for so long and it kind of escalating and we weren't able to make progress and I wasn't able to put the fire out and we were getting hotter and hotter and I was physically so exhausted from moving around and not accomplishing anything, I started to get really overwhelmed with the physical fatigue to the point where I turn to the guy behind me on the line. And I said,

0:10:31.160 --> 0:11:2.290

FR13

:You got to take this nozzle." I was like, I need to move back 15 feet. I was like, I can't do it like I'm. I clearly am unable to find where the fire isn't. No. Mind you, nobody could find it because you can't see even here. But it was to the point where I was so hot and and burning and physically exhausted that I had reached my limit to where I knew that I could not physically do it anymore. So I didn't completely leave my teammates. But I was like, hey, I got a backup 15 feet.

0:11:2.360 --> 0:11:25.880

FR13

OK, so we go on and finish the scenario and we come outside and even though it was a training scenario, I really took it hard like mentally I was very upset with myself because in my mind I had failed my team not being able to do the job that I'm supposed to be doing. So between the physical exhaustion, exhaustion and getting pushed to that spot mentally

0:11:27.420 --> 0:11:41.150

FR13

Was super overwhelming and I even though I knew it was a training scenario and that's what we're there for, is to learn and maybe fail and get better in my head. I have failed my team and that's the one job that I have to do is to protect them and I couldn't.

0:11:41.910 --> 0:11:48.980

FR13

So that was extremely hard. And then if you look at the other side of it, like the the medical side.

0:11:50.50 --> 0:11:54.810

FR13

Riding the medic, you know, we see things that a lot of people don't really get to.

0:11:56.30 --> 0:12:2.230

FR13

And if you take take a bad EMS run that doesn't go the way that you want it to

0:12:3.250 --> 0:12:10.870

FR13

Umm, it's really hard and taxing mentally afterwards, especially if you have a child that maybe

0:12:11.560 --> 0:12:17.990

FR13

No matter, no matter what you do to try to help this child, the child doesn't survive.

0:12:18.740 --> 0:12:51.770

FR13

In that that takes a toll mentally, not during the run because you're so focused on your job and you're kind of almost in, like a robotic mode of, OK, I need to do this. And then I need to do this. And then I need to do this. But when you're done all of those emotions come in and all of the anger and the sadness and the, you know, whatever else it is that you had to endure, mom screaming an ear piercing, gut wrenching scream at the top of her lungs because her baby is dead in front of her, like that kind of stuff.

0:12:52.720 --> 0:12:57.80

FR13

Really takes a toll mentally afterwards, so those are two like kind of



0:12:57.850 --> 0:13:2.740

FR13

Extreme ends of the the spectrum there, but does that answer your questions?

0:13:2.850 --> 0:13:15.740

INTERVIEWER - GA

It does. No, I appreciate you sharing and I can tell, you know how passionate you are about your job, especially like how you described, you know, from the, from the fire to, you know, the the imagery you gave, you know, with an infant.

0:13:16.320 --> 0:13:16.810

FR13

Umm.

0:13:16.960 --> 0:13:20.430

INTERVIEWER - GA

How you're describing I can just tell you're very passionate about your work so.

0:13:20.430 --> 0:13:21.500

FR13

Yes, I am.

0:13:22.990 --> 0:13:26.880

INTERVIEWER - GA

Well, have you ever had or do you have any type of

0:13:27.190 --> 0:13:30.410

INTERVIEWER - GA

Uh, like chronic work related pain

0:13:31.140 --> 0:13:32.670

INTERVIEWER - GA

From that physical stress?

0:13:33.290 --> 0:13:35.320

FR13

No, I don't.

0:13:36.540 --> 0:13:41.220

FR13

But that's part of the reason why I have taken care of myself physically to.

0:13:43.20 --> 0:13:54.700

FR13

To lift weights to keep my joints and my tendons strong. And, you know, just keep my body healthy. So hopefully I can prolong that because typically you start seeing.

0:13:55.480 --> 0:13:56.100

FR13

Uh.

0:13:57.330 --> 0:14:9.670

FR13

The degeneration of like the the knee joints and the shoulders a little bit later in the guys' career. Maybe, you know, 15-20 years later and they start having the knee problems and the shoulder problems and

0:14:10.290 --> 0:14:21.620

FR13

Those chronic issues that can only be resolved with surgery, so I personally have not had a job related chronic injury like that.

0:14:27.380 --> 0:14:27.830

FR13

OK.

0:14:31.330 --> 0:14:31.980

FR13

Yeah.

0:14:23.230 --> 0:14:48.500

INTERVIEWER - GA

Well, that's great to hear. I'm. I'm kind of on the other end. I'm so I'm a physical therapist and so I can appreciate like a lot of the things that you're saying. Do you do you foresee- So you've got, you know, you've got your regimen, it's working for you, you know, you hope that it continues to work for you. I hope it does too. Do you see any type of opportunity in your current workflow to incorporate

0:14:49.300 --> 0:14:58.730

INTERVIEWER - GA

You know some type of well-being resource, be it for physical needs or be it for mental needs, into your into your day?

0:15:1.760 --> 0:15:1.980

FR13

So.

0:15:2.60 --> 0:15:4.790

FR13

So we just started.

0:15:7.70 --> 0:15:13.990

FR13

As far as physical goes, within the last couple weeks have incorporated like a

0:15:15.280 --> 0:15:45.850

FR13

There are titled as Yoga, but it's more of like an active recovery. So we have a group of girls that will come in and they will do active recovery stretches and if we have any ailments we'll, you know, kind of work on those and just trying to keep our bodies a little bit more limber because we're not exactly very good at stretching and taking care of those things. And then we are lucky enough to also have a physical therapist that comes in to the station once a week.

0:15:46.440 --> 0:16:1.850

FR13

Umm, she'll usually come in and she'll do you know the dry needling and the rehab and the the game-ready ice machines and the traction and stuff like that. So we are very fortunate at my department to have that. So those are the physical

0:16:2.510 --> 0:16:8.200

FR13

Kind of aspects that we have and then if we have any need for any

0:16:9.640 --> 0:16:13.910

FR13

Type of mental things. We do have a chaplain that comes around.

0:16:14.910 --> 0:16:21.40

FR13

He usually comes in once a week, maybe once every couple weeks. We'll see him and then if we have any type of critical

0:16:21.900 --> 0:16:28.640

FR13

Runs he will come in after those and debrief with everybody. And do you know like a

0:16:29.720 --> 0:16:30.660

FR13

An emergent

0:16:36.400 --> 0:16:36.780

INTERVIEWER - GA

Right.

0:16:31.890 --> 0:16:39.0

FR13

Just session if if people need to talk about it or go over it or whatever, work through it. So we have those resources.

0:16:40.470 --> 0:16:43.900

FR13

I guess they're not their daily, but we do have those options which are nice.

0:16:45.50 --> 0:16:51.720

INTERVIEWER - GA

What- What barriers do you see to having those resources like in a more frequent on a more frequent basis?

0:16:53.430 --> 0:16:59.610

FR13

Just the uncertainty of when we're gonna be able to one,

0:17:0.320 --> 0:17:10.770

FR13

Even be at the station for them a lot of times, like the the yoga ladies will come in and we'll catch a run while they're there and they're only there for an hour, so we might miss most of the session.

0:17:11.890 --> 0:17:20.690

FR13

As a department we are getting busier so having a scheduled time for somebody to come in can be kind of tough because we can't just

0:17:21.660 --> 0:17:50.470

FR13

Not go on a 911 call because they're there- you know what I mean? So that and on top of all of the other trainings that are required just to be a paramedic and a firefighter that we do as the department each day we typically have something at least one training scheduled, whether it's EMS training or whatever. So we kind of have a busy schedule anyway. So having some of that stuff set daily can be kind of difficult if we're at work.

0:17:51.490 --> 0:18:2.770

INTERVIEWER - GA

And when you say that as a department, you're getting busier, are you, are you handling a higher amount of calls you know is there left staff doing more work? Can you elaborate on that a little bit?

0:18:3.180 --> 0:18:5.410

FR13

So it's more or less just

0:18:7.270 --> 0:18:18.110

FR13

The the township that I work in is growing rapidly. You know, just like everywhere else, housing housing developments going up everywhere. So we're just getting busier and then

0:18:19.30 --> 0:18:36.850

FR13

With that comes more calls and I wouldn't say we're understaffed, but we're not at the need yet to where we're busy enough, where we need to add staffing. But we're definitely kind of in that middle range where at some point we could add staffing. If we keep getting busier, but I wouldn't

0:18:37.550 --> 0:18:40.200

FR13

I definitely wouldn't categorize us as understaffed.

0:18:40.870 --> 0:18:48.880

INTERVIEWER - GA

OK. So a mix of increasing population, more calls and then at some point you may need to scale

0:18:50.730 --> 0:18:50.990

FR13

Yeah.

0:18:49.550 --> 0:18:51.990

INTERVIEWER - GA

Your operations to meet that? Got it. OK.

0:18:53.110 --> 0:18:54.420

INTERVIEWER - GA

What are your thoughts about

0:18:55.890 --> 0:19:0.860

INTERVIEWER - GA

Regarding the incorporation of mindfulness practice like into your daily work life?

0:19:2.520 --> 0:19:7.870

FR13

I would see that as a benefit. I'm definitely not against any of that.

0:19:10.180 --> 0:19:30.370

FR13

I have a little bit of experience with like some meditation, but it's been a long time since I've practiced that, mostly just because it's again setting a time daily to do these things and not procrastinate about it. But I think there's a huge benefit in that.

0:19:31.790 --> 0:19:33.20

FR13

You know any kind of

0:19:33.810 --> 0:19:37.620

FR13

Mindfulness and headspace awareness, I think, could benefit all of us.

0:19:38.920 --> 0:19:45.420

INTERVIEWER - GA

What are your thoughts about using like a stress reduction or mindfulness app during work?

0:20:4.20 --> 0:20:4.490

INTERVIEWER - GA

Um I think that would be an easier solution than having a physical person is just because we can pick and choose the time that we're available to use it. You know what I mean like whether it's right in the

0:20:4.560 --> 0:20:8.250

FR13

Morning when we first get there, right before we go to bed or whatever it is, so I think

0:20:9.340 --> 0:20:12.690

FR13

Having that option to kind of pick our own schedule and

0:20:13.400 --> 0:20:18.910

FR13

You know, as long as it's not a an hour and a half thing every day, I think it would be easy to implement.

0:20:20.240 --> 0:20:25.330

INTERVIEWER - GA

Is there anything in particular that you can think of that would make you like, want to use an app?

0:20:26.190 --> 0:20:28.520

INTERVIEWER - GA

Versus, you know a different medium?

0:20:31.80 --> 0:20:49.160

FR13

I don't know. So obviously this day and age of everything is on the phone and the computer. So a lot of times I'll tend to shy away from that a little bit. I do. I really do like the in person with anything, the less technology, sometimes the better, but

0:20:50.650 --> 0:20:55.40

FR13

That's not really the direction we're going, and we can't always do that, so

0:20:57.770 --> 0:20:58.800

FR13

As far as

0:21:1.600 --> 0:21:3.490

INTERVIEWER - GA

I know you. I know you.

0:21:1.400 --> 0:21:5.240

FR13

I don't know what would make me want to use it. Sorry, go ahead.

0:21:4.420 --> 0:21:9.600

INTERVIEWER - GA

OK. OK. No, no, that's that's good information to have. So earlier you had mentioned that

0:21:10.500 --> 0:21:15.810

INTERVIEWER - GA

You know, being able to pick the times that you wanted to incorporate mindfulness.

0:21:16.930 --> 0:21:26.200

INTERVIEWER - GA

You saw that as a benefit and I was curious if you if you thought if you had given any thought to you know, other aspects that would be beneficial?

0:21:30.350 --> 0:21:32.550

FR13

Other aspects as far as

0:21:33.320 --> 0:21:35.110

FR13

Can you elaborate a little bit on that?

0:21:34.640 --> 0:21:38.10

INTERVIEWER - GA

Yeah, yeah, sure. Uh, like if of incorporating it into your practice.

0:21:42.290 --> 0:21:49.0

FR13

Not really. So if I personally, if I'm gonna use a mindfulness app, it's probably gonna be before bed.

0:21:49.750 --> 0:22:2.740

FR13

Umm. So if there's any way I can incorporate that into my routine that I'm already doing at night, you know, trying to wind down for the night, whether it's after my shower and brushing teeth and all that stuff or

0:22:4.80 --> 0:22:10.570

FR13

If I could incorporate that somehow, because that's the time that I need to unwind and kind of

0:22:12.930 --> 0:22:20.510

FR13

Destress the most and you know a lot of people have trouble sleeping and being able to turn my brain off or slow it down a little bit.

0:22:21.870 --> 0:22:23.720

FR13

In the evenings would be super helpful.

0:22:25.120 --> 0:22:27.700

INTERVIEWER - GA

Do you think it's something that could be incorporated during work?

0:22:28.330 --> 0:22:30.60

FR13

Yes. Yeah, so.

0:22:30.780 --> 0:22:31.250

FR13

Umm.

0:22:33.270 --> 0:22:54.880

FR13

At work, so we typically run a like 9 to 5 or 8 to 5 schedule. That's when we're doing our trainings and things during the day. And then obviously if we get a run after 5 o'clock we go on it. But the day is hours after that. So the evenings are typically the slowest when we're unwinding after dinner, just trying to relax and kind of

0:22:56.730 --> 0:23:5.500

FR13

Just unwind a little bit. So I think that's the perfect time to do it at work is probably in the evenings when there's less to worry about, less things to do.

0:23:6.290 --> 0:23:9.470

FR13

And just kind of unwind a little bit from the busy day.

0:23:9.940 --> 0:23:11.940

INTERVIEWER - GA

OK. So kind of that sweet spot.

0:23:12.290 --> 0:23:13.90

FR13

Yeah.

0:23:13.770 --> 0:23:18.240

INTERVIEWER - GA

Do you think coworkers would be interested in using an app?

0:23:20.240 --> 0:23:21.790

FR13

So I think-

0:23:22.900 --> 0:23:24.560

FR13

Is it something-

0:23:26.360 --> 0:23:32.870

FR13

Is it something that can be done as a group with one app or is it something that has to be done?

0:23:46.420 --> 0:23:47.20

INTERVIEWER - GA

Oh, interesting.



0:23:47.960 --> 0:23:48.230

INTERVIEWER - GA

OK.

0:23:33.650 --> 0:23:51.940

FR13

With each person on their phone using the app? And what I mean by that is like we have our strength trainer at work has an app for our workouts that we have to go in and log every day that we do them. The weights we use and all this stuff, yeah, so we all have to do it separately, but we're doing the same workout.

0:23:52.880 --> 0:23:54.740

INTERVIEWER - GA

Got it, I think-

0:23:54.20 --> 0:23:57.670

FR13

So as far as a mindfulness app goes, is that kind of the same concept?

0:23:58.180 --> 0:24:1.690

INTERVIEWER - GA

It it could be either, you know it really could just be

0:24:2.580 --> 0:24:6.290

INTERVIEWER - GA

Whatever suits the individual or whatever you know would work best.

0:24:7.910 --> 0:24:10.740

FR13

Yeah. So my crew that I'm with specifically

0:24:11.910 --> 0:24:17.710

FR13

I think would be open to that, especially if we did it- If we could do it together because

0:24:18.810 --> 0:24:43.80

FR13

Like in the evenings, for example, it's usually around 8:00 PM. We call it tea time, so we'll get our our little cup of tea and we'll sit there and unwind in the chair. And just, like, sip on tea and watch some TV. But that's the time that we kind of all spend together. So if we had the opportunity to also maybe incorporate, like, a mindfulness thing during that period, while we're all kind of together anyway.

0:24:43.920 --> 0:24:44.420

FR13

I think.

0:24:43.970 --> 0:24:44.610

INTERVIEWER - GA

So you.

0:24:45.660 --> 0:24:46.210

INTERVIEWER - GA

Oh, go ahead.

0:24:45.690 --> 0:24:47.10

FR13

That would be different, yeah.

0:24:47.180 --> 0:25:4.780

INTERVIEWER - GA

OK, so similar to what you had described with like the exercise logging, do you think it would be or at least it sounds like what you're saying that it would be more beneficial if everybody was going as a group was going through the same mindfulness content at the same time. Is that what you're saying?

0:25:5.330 --> 0:25:21.270

FR13

Yes. Like if we we all did the same thing at once. Now I don't know. So like the workout program specifically, I actually don't have it. I don't I do the workouts, but I don't log them because it's just one more thing for me to get on my phone and have to do.

0:25:27.930 --> 0:25:28.230

INTERVIEWER - GA

OK.

0:25:21.870 --> 0:25:34.860

FR13

But I do it with everybody because I, you know, enjoy that aspect. So I I think doing all of us doing the same thing together is good, but I don't know if it's.

0:25:35.620 --> 0:25:45.310

FR13

Like if we all had to get on there and log the same thing, but if it's a 15 minute, you know kind of a deal that's different then.

0:25:46.470 --> 0:25:49.930

FR13

Having a log my entire hour workout every day or whatever.

0:25:50.340 --> 0:25:51.600

INTERVIEWER - GA

Sure. OK.

0:25:51.300 --> 0:25:59.190

FR13

And if so, I think that that would be probably, well, better well perceived with the the group that I'm with anyway.

0:25:59.780 --> 0:26:4.810

INTERVIEWER - GA

OK. No, that's great information. Do you or what, what barriers then would you see

0:26:5.670 --> 0:26:16.680

INTERVIEWER - GA

Using some type of app during the work day? So I I know you know if identified this kind of sweet spot after the somewhat you know traditional day ends.

0:26:16.910 --> 0:26:17.330

FR13

Umm.

0:26:17.940 --> 0:26:19.810

INTERVIEWER - GA

Why wouldn't that work during the day?

0:26:20.560 --> 0:26:25.580

FR13

Well, I don't think it wouldn't work. I just, I just think

0:26:33.120 --> 0:26:33.380

INTERVIEWER - GA

Yeah.

0:26:28.760 --> 0:26:43.220

FR13

It's one more thing to do during the day, if that makes sense, but but not all of our days are super busy, so not every day there's stuff going on from 8 to 5 like I worked

0:26:43.900 --> 0:26:59.10

FR13

Umm, I worked Saturday and Sunday. I just got off of work today. I worked at 48-hour shift. Saturday was super busy doing a bunch of stuff, but yesterday we didn't do much at all. So like we could have picked at any point during the day to be able to use a mindfulness app.

0:26:59.900 --> 0:27:0.400

FR13

Umm.

0:27:1.970 --> 0:27:2.400

FR13

Yeah.

0:27:3.30 --> 0:27:9.200

INTERVIEWER - GA

So is it? Is it the just a lack of consistency, you know, across the days that it would make it difficult?

0:27:9.600 --> 0:27:14.830

FR13

Yeah, I would say that because not every day if things are scheduled at the same time and

0:27:15.720 --> 0:27:19.680

FR13

So I would say consistency is definitely the right word for that.

0:27:20.520 --> 0:27:20.900

INTERVIEWER - GA

OK.

0:27:22.330 --> 0:27:24.600

INTERVIEWER - GA

What information do you think would be important

0:27:25.520 --> 0:27:26.650

INTERVIEWER - GA

To include an app?

0:27:27.770 --> 0:27:28.610

FR13

Umm.

0:27:32.580 --> 0:27:33.50

INTERVIEWER - GA

Yes.

0:27:30.150 --> 0:27:34.20

FR13

As far as a mindfulness app or just in general or?

0:27:34.870 --> 0:27:39.170

INTERVIEWER - GA

Or in general, you know, if you if there's something in particular that you think of. But yes, for a mindfulness that.

0:27:43.720 --> 0:27:46.210

FR13

I would say maybe a timer.

0:27:47.70 --> 0:27:47.440

INTERVIEWER - GA

OK.

0:27:47.840 --> 0:27:49.30

FR13

As far as.

0:27:49.880 --> 0:27:55.720

FR13

You know, we're always, I would say the Fire department's a little tricky because we're a lot less.

0:27:57.840 --> 0:27:59.910

FR13

I don't want to say scheduled, we're a lot less

0:28:0.640 --> 0:28:7.670

FR13

Consistent than all of the other jobs out there, you know, every other job is we're doing this from this time to this time every day.

0:28:8.770 --> 0:28:29.760

FR13

So the fire department's kind of hard because, like I said, we've got stuff going on all the time. But if there can be some manner of timer on it to keep you accountable and then that way it keeps you focused. And then when that timer goes off, you can kind of go about whatever else you were doing and kind of change your focus, but for me

0:28:31.500 --> 0:28:51.520

FR13

Who- Someone who struggles with staying focused anyway, because that's the age that we live in. If I have a timer set and I know that from the time I hit the button to the time that it goes off that that is all my attentions focused on and I'm not focused on worrying about how much time do I have left or how much time have I given or you know what I mean?

0:28:52.0 --> 0:28:52.460

INTERVIEWER - GA

Yeah.

0:28:53.350 --> 0:28:54.540

INTERVIEWER - GA

Have you thought about?

0:28:55.550 --> 0:28:58.580

INTERVIEWER - GA

So it sounds like what you're describing is

0:28:59.280 --> 0:29:0.290

INTERVIEWER - GA

Almost like a.

0:29:1.20 --> 0:29:17.340

INTERVIEWER - GA

It's it's an approach or or you'd have a lot of autonomy. So I've got, you know, let's say we ink out 15 minutes, you know, and then let me know when it's done. Have you thought about, like, whether or not you would want something that provides you with guidance or, you know, to guide you through which?

0:29:15.880 --> 0:29:17.840

FR13

Yes, that would be super helpful.

0:29:18.190 --> 0:29:24.40

INTERVIEWER - GA

OK. Is that something that you think you would prefer over just having a set time every day?

0:29:25.50 --> 0:29:27.40

FR13

I would prefer it to be guided.

0:29:27.160 --> 0:29:37.410

FR13

Umm, just because I found if I'm doing some kind of meditation that's not guided and I'm not doing it every day anyway I-

0:29:38.60 --> 0:29:40.170

FR13

It can be hard to stay focused.

0:29:41.170 --> 0:29:50.110

FR13

If somebody's not guiding you through what you should be doing, and OK, do this now and then do this. And I think that would be helpful than just-

0:29:51.400 --> 0:29:56.220

FR13

Sitting there trying to figure it out for 15 minutes or whatever the time frame is.

0:29:57.310 --> 0:30:00.520

INTERVIEWER - GA

And in your mind, do you envision

0:30:1.560 --> 0:30:9.230

INTERVIEWER - GA

A like audio or video? You know, how do you envision that guidance or what do you think would be best?

0:30:10.80 --> 0:30:16.630

FR13

I would prefer probably an audio because when I think of mindfulness, I think of, you know, my eyes are closed.

0:30:17.450 --> 0:30:30.970

FR13

And my body is relaxed and then I can just sit there and just listen and have less distractions of trying to look around the room or look at the video and listen and focus on what I'm doing. So it just takes 1 less

0:30:31.660 --> 0:30:35.810

FR13

Umm kind of distraction out of the equation and you can really just listen.

0:30:37.310 --> 0:30:43.680

INTERVIEWER - GA

And what would you want to be present, whether it was, you know, an audio or a video? Like what would you want to be present

0:30:45.240 --> 0:30:48.520

INTERVIEWER - GA

In that content, you know when you're watching it in the app?

0:30:49.600 --> 0:30:52.660

FR13

Probably some kind of breathwork.

0:30:56.550 --> 0:30:57.640

INTERVIEWER - GA

Yes. Yep.

0:30:53.630 --> 0:30:59.610

FR13

And is that kind of what we're looking for as far as, yeah, like like a breath work or?

0:31:1.210 --> 0:31:3.760

FR13

I guess that would also be incorporated with.

0:31:5.220 --> 0:31:7.210

FR13

I don't know what it's called when you

0:31:8.170 --> 0:31:13.760

FR13

You breathe in and then you focus on like a certain body part to relax or like, just things like that.

0:31:15.330 --> 0:31:20.100

FR13

But I think breathing is probably the biggest thing because that's the easiest way to release tension.

0:31:21.180 --> 0:31:28.340

INTERVIEWER - GA

Do you think there's someone in particular who should guide the mindfulness, be it in audio or video?

0:31:28.990 --> 0:31:36.870

INTERVIEWER - GA

Do you think it be perceived you know differently if it was person A versus, you know a a medical professional or another first responder?

0:31:38.350 --> 0:31:44.170

FR13

No, not really. I think if it is somebody that that's what they specialize in.

0:31:44.240 --> 0:31:51.960

FR13

It's going to be perceived better than Joe Schmoe with a monotonous voice

0:31:55.640 --> 0:31:56.110

INTERVIEWER - GA

Right.

0:31:52.650 --> 0:32:1.750

FR13

Telling ya to take a deep breath. You know what I mean? So as long as it's somebody that's skilled in what they're doing, I don't think it matters who it is.

0:32:7.390 --> 0:32:7.920

FR13

Umm.

0:32:3.170 --> 0:32:8.50

INTERVIEWER - GA

OK, so as long as it's a, you know a content expert or in that domain?

0:32:8.630 --> 0:32:9.170

FR13

Mm-hmm.

0:32:8.920 --> 0:32:9.750

INTERVIEWER - GA

That would be OK.

0:32:10.630 --> 0:32:10.990

INTERVIEWER - GA

OK.

0:32:10.220 --> 0:32:11.410

FR13

Yeah, absolutely.

0:32:12.460 --> 0:32:24.690

INTERVIEWER - GA

Is there anything so as far as you know, questions, we've we've hit all of them are there. Are there any questions or anything you'd like to go back to that we've discussed or having, you know, hashed some of this stuff out



0:32:25.310 --> 0:32:27.460

INTERVIEWER - GA

That you want to further elaborate on?

0:32:28.340 --> 0:32:29.840

FR13

I don't think so.

0:32:31.260 --> 0:32:32.40

FR13

So.

0:32:34.70 --> 0:32:42.360

FR13

I mean, where are you guys at I guess with this process of the mindfulness app for first responders? Is this just like the very beginning

0:32:42.940 --> 0:32:44.70

FR13

For this part of it?

0:32:44.980 --> 0:32:58.280

INTERVIEWER - GA

Yeah. So what we're currently working on is designing a work based stress reduction program in a manner that would be most beneficial to those who are experienced that occupational stress.

0:32:59.500 --> 0:33:1.340

INTERVIEWER - GA

And in a manner that would be useful to them.

0:33:3.320 --> 0:33:3.770

FR13

OK.

0:33:4.950 --> 0:33:16.850

FR13

Yeah, I don't. I don't think I have any other questions. I'm sure I'll think of them when we're not on here anymore. But do you have any more questions or follow-ups or need anymore elaborations on anything else?

0:33:17.660 --> 0:33:28.70

INTERVIEWER - GA

I just have one last question. Is that do you think that there would be or is there anything that you feel like we should absolutely know as we're designing

0:33:28.990 --> 0:33:29.640

INTERVIEWER - GA

The program?

0:33:32.850 --> 0:33:36.280

FR13

I don't think so. So the good news is

0:33:37.720 --> 0:33:44.180

FR13

With this program and doing it now, I think it's gonna be a little bit better perceived than it would have

0:33:44.860 --> 0:33:50.140

FR13

You know, five or ten years ago because we are getting out of that era where

0:33:50.800 --> 0:34:21.650

FR13

You just sit there and hold it all in and you know, and a lot of the older guys that have been around for a while maybe aren't going to be as open to this, but especially in the fire department, we are so young now. We have so much turnover that I think now's probably going to be one of the better times to try to implement something like this and and really maybe help out some of the younger generation that doesn't have a lot of experience with that occupational stress. So to be able to

0:34:21.750 --> 0:34:23.900

FR13

Implement these good routines now.

0:34:25.200 --> 0:34:28.270

FR13

I think is gonna be super helpful for sure.

0:34:29.80 --> 0:34:47.500

INTERVIEWER - GA

Do you think there's a certain way that you would frame such a program or present it, you know, to first responders that would help them be more receptive to such a program? I know you'd mentioned, like the older gentleman maybe there's, maybe there's some, you know, stigma that exists about-

0:34:48.180 --> 0:34:54.860

INTERVIEWER - GA

You know, seeking uh resources for your mental health. Is there like a certain way you would frame it or?

0:34:57.850 --> 0:34:59.870

FR13

If you tell them that

0:35:1.40 --> 0:35:32.170

FR13

You know, taking advantage of the mindfulness app, you know, at work gives you a whatever it is 15 or 30 minute, basically relaxing nap time. That would be, they would perceive that really well if it could just be, you know, a short period of time where they are not focused on EMS training and and physical

fitness training. And it's just a time where we can sit there and decompress and like, just relax. I think anybody in the fire service

0:35:32.290 --> 0:35:33.900

FR13

Or the first responders should

0:35:34.530 --> 0:35:49.700

FR13

Perceive that well because our job is usually boom, boom, boom, high stress. You know, always something going on. So if you're like, hey, you know, this is an opportunity for you to just chill out and decompress for a half an hour. I that will be perceived well for sure.

0:35:50.620 --> 0:36:2.570

INTERVIEWER - GA

OK. Well, thank you so much, uh, for just the feedback. Like the stories, sharing your story and helping you know shape what this program might look like.